

A market is a simple equation.

And always has been.

Tokenisation won't change what makes a market — only **where** it is made, and whether decentralised finance can deliver on its promise. That is being decided now.

SET ASIDE THE COMPLEXITY

Buyers and sellers → make a trade

Trust and liquidity → bring them back

A place to meet → makes it a market

ASSET what is traded

TECHNOLOGY how it moves

CURRENCY the most visible part, and the least

VENUE **the market itself**

Win the venue, and the asset comes to you.

Champagne fairs

12th–16th c.

the model

Royal Exchange

London, 1571

the venue

Lloyd's coffee house

c.1688

the insurance market

Eurodollar market

late 1950s

someone else's currency

Today

2025

both markets

London won the century's greatest currency market with someone else's currency.

Four properties of the **place** — not the unit.

Continuity

English commercial law, unbroken for centuries — and continuous *through* reinvention, not despite it.

Legal certainty

GMRA, ISDA, and now tokenised assets as property under English law. The trade *and* the asset are certain.

Concentration

37.8% of global FX, 49.6% of OTC rates. The largest centre for both — because everyone is already in the room.

Convenience

Settles between the Asian close and the US open — one place, one law, one language. The flywheel of return.

London leads today —
the **next** venue is forming **offshore**.

UK share of global FX & OTC rates **37.8% · 49.6%**

Currency of the tokenised cash leg **~99% USD**

Live tokenised issuance & repo venues **CH · HK · SG · US**

UK sovereign digital issuance **£0** pilot

Tokenisation upside by 2035 — if the UK leads **£33bn/yr**

THE FLOWS ARE THE MARKET

An FX swap is a repo in two currencies.

FX swaps are the single most-traded instrument in the market — \$4 trillion a day. Round-the-clock trading needs round-the-clock funding: new collateral, new ways to pay, and the FX to cover the risk.

**Move one onchain,
and you move the market.**

Much of the most open financial architecture ever conceived is being built the old way — behind closed doors, by invitation.

**You cannot build
an open market with
a closed method.**

**What got us here
will not get us there.**

The venue is there to be won.

London has every principle for a fair, transparent, open market. Now we must move **principles into action** — take what markets already do, and rebuild it, pattern by pattern, in the open.

As markets move to 24×7, there is no time to wait.

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